

“JAMNALALJI WAS RATHER UNIQUE IN HIS OWN WAY…HIS ABSOLUTE INTEGRITY AND HONESTY OF PURPOSE ENDEARED HIM TO US.”

Jawaharlal Nehru, 1951

Born into poverty in the princely state of Jaipur, **Jamnalal Bajaj** was the adopted grandson of Bacchraj Bajaj, head of a wealthy business family in Wardha, Gujarat. Jamnalal successfully expanded the business into what is today the Bajaj Group. Despite his wealth, he lived austerely, taking to heart Gandhi’s philosophy that the wealthy are merely trustees who have a duty to use their wealth for social good. Bajaj saw Gandhi as a spiritual father, and the two men worked closely on Gandhi’s constructive programmes in rural India. He served as the Congress party’s treasurer for twenty years, and was involved in all of the party’s major campaigns. Bajaj served time in prison for being part of the nationalist movement.